

THE FIRST FEW DAYS

Take these one at a time. Nothing here has to happen all at once.



- [ ] Call close family and friends (ask one person to help spread the word)
- [ ] Contact a funeral home or cremation provider
- [ ] Look for written wishes, a will, or a pre-arranged plan
- [ ] Choose one helper to coordinate calls, meals and visitors
- [ ] Arrange care for children, pets and the home
- [ ] Let their employer know, if they were working
- [ ] Ask the funeral home about copies of the death certificate
- [ ] Keep the home, car and valuables secure
- [ ] Start a list of who sent food, flowers or help (for thank-you notes later)



PLANNING THE SERVICE

A gathering that feels like them matters more than getting everything perfect.

- [ ] Choose the kind of gathering: funeral, memorial, celebration of life, graveside
- [ ] Set the date, time and place
- [ ] Ask someone to officiate or lead the service
- [ ] Invite speakers and readers; choose verses, poems or readings
- [ ] Choose music for arrival, the service and leaving
- [ ] Gather photos for a display table or slideshow
- [ ] Write the obituary or announcement
- [ ] Make the program (order of service)
- [ ] Make a welcome sign and share-a-memory cards for guests
- [ ] Plan the reception: place, food, guest book
- [ ] Decide on flowers, or an 'in lieu of flowers' charity
- [ ] Choose pallbearers, if needed

AFTER THE SERVICE

Grief keeps its own time. Come back to this page whenever you're ready.

- [ ] Send thank-you notes to those who helped
- [ ] Keep important papers together in one folder
- [ ] Notify banks, insurers and government offices (the funeral home can advise)
- [ ] Cancel or transfer subscriptions, phone and utilities
- [ ] Share photos and memories collected at the service with family
- [ ] Be gentle with yourself, and let people help

KEY CONTACTS

Funeral home _____

Officiant _____

Venue _____

Florist _____

Print shop _____

NOTES

When you're ready to make the program, welcome sign and memory cards, our fill-in Soft Botanical kit is at payhip.com/ForeverHeld. You type, save and print. No design skills needed.